Set Up Your my Social Security Account

A step-by-step guide from Southern Oak Financial & Wellness. Your free online account at ssa.gov lets you check your application status, get your benefit letter, see your earnings record, and more.

Who Can Create an Account?

You can create a free **my Social Security** account if you:

☐ Are at least 18 years old
☐ Have a Social Security number
☐ Have a U.S. mailing address
☐ Have an email address you can open

WHO NEEDS TO BE THERE — THIS PART MATTERS:
Only **you** can create your own account. Social Security does not allow anyone else — not a spouse, not a family member, not an advocate, not a representative — to create an account for you or to use your account. **You must be there yourself**, enter your own information, create your own password, and type in your own security codes. If the sign-up asks for a photo of your ID or a selfie, that must be you, in person.

A helper (like Southern Oak) may sit with you and guide you step by step — that is fine and often helps. But your password and codes are yours alone. **Never share them with anyone**, including us.

What You Need Before You Start

☐ Your Social Security number and date of birth
☐ An email address you can open right now (needed to confirm your account)
☐ A phone that can receive text messages or calls (for security codes). No mobile phone? There are other choices, like backup codes or a security key.
☐ A government photo ID — driver's license, state ID card, or passport
☐ A phone or computer with a camera, if you use ID.me (for a photo of your ID and a selfie)
☐ About 10 to 15 quiet minutes

The Steps

Step 1. On a computer or phone, go to **ssa.gov/myaccount**. Type the address yourself — never use a link from a text or email.

Step 2. Choose **“Create an Account.”**

Step 3. Choose how you will sign in: **Login.gov** or **ID.me**. Social Security uses these two trusted services to prove who you are. You only need one. If you already have an account with either one, sign in with it.

Step 4. Type your email address and confirm it. They will email you a link or code — open your email and follow it.

Step 5. Create a strong password. Write it down and keep it somewhere safe at home. Do not share it with anyone.

Step 6. Set up your security check (multi-factor authentication). The most common choice is a code sent by text message to your phone each time you sign in.

Step 7. Agree to share your information with Social Security, then **prove your identity**. You will enter your name, Social Security number, date of birth, and address, and show your photo ID. With ID.me, you take a photo of your ID and a selfie, or you can verify on a video call with an ID.me agent.

Step 8. If your identity cannot be proven online, do not give up. You may be offered a video call, an in-person option, or a code mailed to your home address. Follow the instructions on the screen.

Step 9. Back on the Social Security site, agree to the terms. Your account is ready. You will land on your personal my Social Security home page.

What You Can Do With Your Account

- Check the status of an application or appeal
- Get a benefit verification letter (proof of benefits)
- Get a replacement SSA-1099 tax form
- See your earnings record and your Social Security Statement
- Get estimates of future benefits
- Change your address and phone number (address change is not available if you receive SSI)
- Start or change direct deposit (if you receive benefits)
- Request a replacement Social Security card (in most states)

Stay Safe

- The account is **free**. Never pay anyone to create it for you.
- Only use **ssa.gov**. Social Security will never text or email you a link asking you to sign in.
- Never share your password or your sign-in codes — not with family, not with us, not with anyone who calls you.

Need help? Book an appointment at southernoakfw.org and we will sit with you and guide you through these steps while **you** create **your** account. You can also call Social Security at 1-800-772-1213 (TTY 1-800-325-0778).